number of foreign fighters joined the movement, from virtually every part of the world. ISIS developed many of the trappings of a state, including a revenue model, taxation system, social services, and a flag. But eventually, its efforts proved unsustainable, its two main capitals—Mosul in Iraq and Raqqa in Syria—fell in 2017, and al-Baghdadi was killed. Despite its military defeat and loss of territory, the widespread appeal of ISIS recruitment and the regularity of ISIS-inspired terrorist attacks around the world suggest that violent Islamist extremism retains its allure. The return of the Taliban in Afghanistan in 2021 may yet galvanize other violent Islamist groups and raises the prospect of renewed terrorism in the West, South, Southeast, and Central Asia.

Following the 'Arab Spring', India's approach to the broader region has altered significantly. Most importantly, it has led to several Arab countries —including in the Gulf—reconsidering their post-1979 relationships with Islamist groups and attempting to modernize their economies and societies. This has translated into greater counter-terrorism cooperation with countries like India and Israel, as well as a renewed appreciation for the economic value of these new partners. [14] Whereas the likes of the UAE and Saudi Arabia had once been supportive of and sympathetic to the Afghan Taliban and Pakistan's claims to Kashmir, recent developments have led to a readjustment in their positions on these and other issues. Meanwhile, some Gulf states, such as Qatar, as well as non-Arab regional powers such as Iran and Turkey have attempted to fill the void by propping up more conservative Islamist movements in the region.

Other long-term strategic, political, and economic factors are contributing to the restructuring of the regional architecture. The geopolitical rivalry between Saudi Arabia, and Iran continues to play out, including through proxies in Yemen and Lebanon. Saudi and Emirati frustrations with Pakistan, such as over the war in Yemen, have also added to the appreciation for better relations with India. There is a generational change underway, with new leaders in Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and Qatar who do not necessarily carry the baggage of their predecessors and are open to new possibilities. The Gulf economies are also beginning to plan for a